Sales Performance Analysis: Regional, Category and Trend Review

Analysis of retail sales performance, 2014–2017

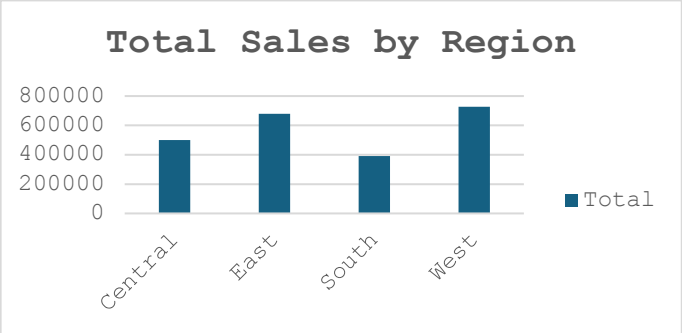
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Executive Summary

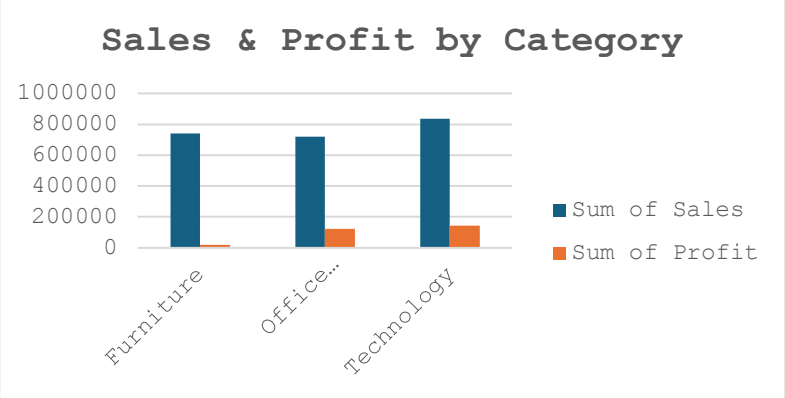
This report analyses 9,994 retail transactions from 2014–2017 to understand regional performance, product profitability, and sales trends over time. The analysis found the West region leads on total revenue, while the Technology category delivers the strongest profit margin despite Furniture generating comparable sales. We recommend a pricing review of Furniture discounting practices, and increased inventory/staffing ahead of the Q4 seasonal peak.

Regional Performance



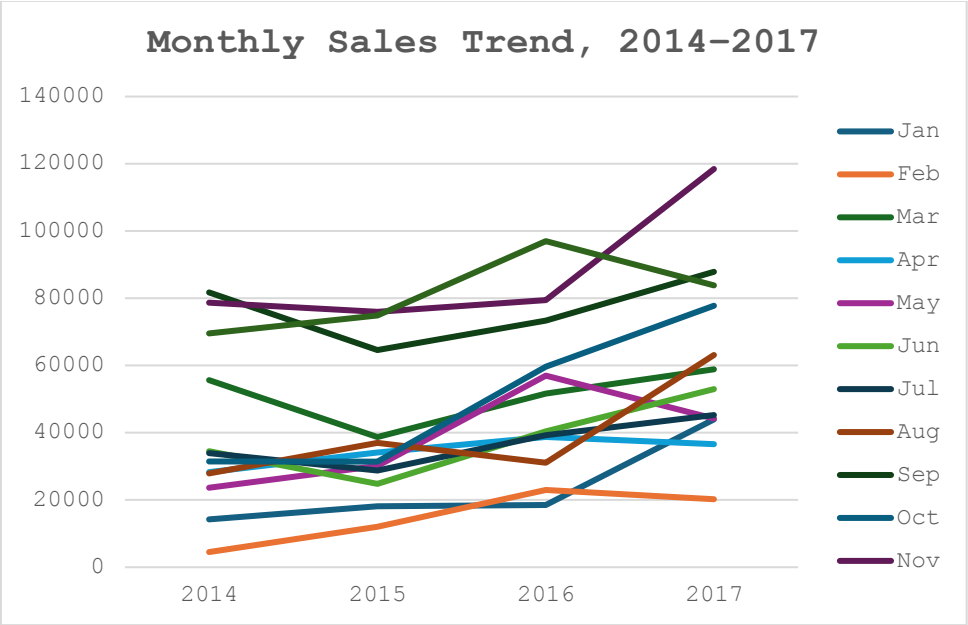
The West region generates the highest total revenue at $725,457.82, notably ahead of other regions. This suggests West-region strategies (staffing, marketing, or product mix) may be worth studying and replicating in weaker-performing regions.

Product Performance



Technology leads on both revenue and profit margin (17.4%), making it the strongest category overall. Furniture generates comparable revenue to Technology, but only a 2.49% margin, suggesting discounting on Furniture items may be cutting too deeply into profitability. Office Supplies sits in between, with a reasonable 17.04% margin on lower overall volume.

Sales Trends



Sales show a consistent seasonal pattern across all four years, with January and February reliably the weakest months and September to December showing a sharp, sustained peak. This peak is consistent with Christmas/Q4 shopping behaviour. Overall revenue also trends upward year-over-year, with November 2017 being the single highest month recorded in the dataset.

Recommendations

- Review Furniture pricing and discount practices to improve its 2.49% margin, given its Technology-comparable sales volume.
- Increase inventory and staffing levels ahead of Q3/Q4 each year to meet the consistent seasonal demand spike.
- Investigate what's driving the West region's strong performance and assess whether those factors can be replicated in weaker regions.